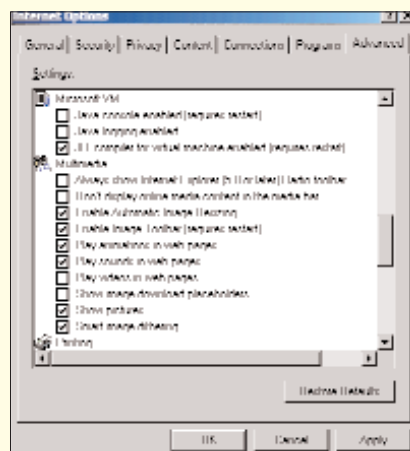


Disable animation and sound

Irritated by the time it takes for sites to load all the images? You can make the Web pages load faster



Block unwanted distractions

provided you are willing to compromise on certain applications. Disable

options such as playing videos, animation, sound and even images. The Web pages will then load in a jiffy.

Blocking cookies

Most Web sites today place a cookie on your computer whenever you visit them. These are sometimes used to identify surfers when they come back to the Web site. Because cookies often contain personal information, you might want to prevent them being stored on your drive.

This can be prevented in most browsers. If you are using IE 6, go to **Tools > Internet options > Privacy** and adjust the settings to ensure that only sites that you trust will be allowed to store these cookies.

Increasing cache

Whenever you visit a Web site, the graphics and the text on the pages get stored in your computer's cache. This allows the browser to load Web pages faster when you next visit the site by reading data from the cache. The larger the size of the cache, the more the amount of data that can be stored, and the faster will be the browsing.

However, an increase in the size of the cache will take up valuable disk space. To find the right balance

you should experiment with the size of the cache. Do this by going to **Tools > Internet Options > General > Settings** and use the slider to increase or decrease the size of your cache.

Disabling automatic refreshing

Every time you visit a site you've been to before, the browser tries automatically refreshing the contents of that page.

This means a wastage of bandwidth in case the information on the page does not change often. One can avoid this by going to **Tools > Internet Options > General > Setting > Never**. However, on dynamic pages like the home page of a portal you need to remember to press [F5] (the Refresh key) so that you don't end up looking at old information.

Remove IE icon from desktop

For those who like a minimum of clutter on their desktops you can remove the icon of Internet Explorer by going to **Tools > Internet Options > Advanced**. There you can scroll down till you see the option of 'Show Internet Explorer on Desktop'. Uncheck that option and the Internet Explorer icon will disappear from the desktop.

Keep your passwords private

If you surf from an Internet café you should check to see that your browser is not saving your passwords in its



PC-TO-PC CALLS

Buddy Phone, Yahoo! and MSN Messenger allow users to make phone calls from one computer to another, provided both computers are online. If you would like to use this facility in MSN Messenger, select your friend's name from the list and go to **Actions > Start a voice conversation**. This can also be done by right-clicking on the person's name and selecting the option of 'Start a Voice Conversation'. After the opposite person has accepted your request, you can start talking into the microphone.

cache. This might allow people who use the system later to access your private e-mail account. To disable this you will need to go to **Tools > Internet Options > Content > AutoComplete Settings** and disable the 'User names and passwords on forms' option.

Use a firewall

Installing a firewall is a must for those hooked to the Net. A firewall not only protects you from attacks from the outside but also against Trojans. There are several personal firewalls that provide protection against these. ZoneAlarm is one such free software, which allows you to select the programs which are allowed access to the Internet.



BROWSING OFFLINE

Quite often you may want to refer to a page that you have visited at some point in time. While finding the link in your browser's History is not too difficult, you can view the site without actually logging on to the Internet by going to **File > Work Offline**. Then just click on a link in your History folder to view the complete page from your hard disk.



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